RSPM — Requirements Specification Module

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OOF® Origin Open Foundation®

Independent Methodological Authority

Architecture: SLGA™ — Software Lifecycle Governance Architecture

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Category: Governance & Enforcement

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GIE-Compatible: Yes

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF® — OriginOpen® Foundation

Protection: MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

The Requirements Specification Module (RSPM) governs how proposed software

requirements are identified, interpreted, formulated, classified, evaluated for specification quality, assessed for material completeness and consistency, and represented as identifiable requirements capable of entering subsequent software requirements governance.

RSPM establishes the methodological conditions under which a software

requirement can be considered sufficiently specified for evaluation, acceptance, scope determination, and lifecycle use.

It connects proposed requirements to the applicable Governed Software

Purpose State while preserving the distinction between what has been requested, what has been interpreted, what has been specified, and what has been legitimately accepted.

RSPM applies to requirements originating from humans, organizations, AI

agents, autonomous systems, automated analysis, existing software behavior, and other competent sources.

It does not assume that a requirement becomes legitimate merely because it is clear, technically feasible, or automatically generated.

Its principal output is:

Governed Software Requirements Specification State

Its foundational distinction is:

Documented Requirement ≠ Governed Requirement Specification.

Operational Role

The operational role of RSPM is:

To transform proposed software requirements into identifiable,

sufficiently explicit, assessable, and purpose-aligned requirement specifications while preserving their origin, interpretation, assumptions, uncertainty, conflicts, completeness limitations, and acceptance boundaries.

RSPM establishes what each requirement means and whether the proposed

requirements collectively provide a sufficiently defined representation of the intended software purpose.

It does not independently authorize implementation.

Nor does it establish that the specified software has been built, tested, or demonstrated to operate successfully.

Position in the SRS Internal Governance Flow

The SRS internal governance flow is:

Software Purpose Definition → Requirements Specification → Software Scope

Management → Requirements Change Control → Requirements Traceability

RSPM governs:

Requirements Specification

It is the second Core Module of SRS.

Its principal upstream input is:

Governed Software Purpose State

produced by:

SPDM — Software Purpose Definition Module

Additional inputs may include stakeholder requests, operational observations, applicable constraints, existing requirements, relevant system evidence, and proposed requirements generated by automated systems.

Its principal output is:

Governed Software Requirements Specification State

That state proceeds to:

SSMM — Software Scope Management Module

RSPM also provides specification information required by subsequent

requirements change and traceability governance.

Central Operational Question

How can proposed software requirements be transformed into sufficiently clear, complete, consistent, assessable, and purpose-aligned specifications without allowing interpretation, technical feasibility, or automated generation to substitute for legitimate requirements acceptance?

Software Requirement Governance Object

Every RSPM assessment must identify the Software Requirement Governance Object.

The object represents an individual proposed requirement or a defined set

of related requirements undergoing specification governance.

Each requirement should have, where applicable:

• A stable requirement identifier

• A requirement statement

• An identifiable origin

• A relationship to the governed software purpose

• A requirement classification

• Relevant assumptions and dependencies

• A specification version

• An evaluation and acceptance state

• Supporting evidence and known limitations

A requirement identifier must remain distinguishable from the text or representation used to express the requirement.

Requirement Identity ≠ Requirement Wording.

Rewording a requirement does not necessarily create a new requirement.

Conversely, preserving the same identifier does not justify concealing a material change in meaning.

Requirements Input and Origin Governance

RSPM shall identify the origin and form of proposed requirements.

Inputs may include:

• Explicit stakeholder requests

• Business or operational needs

• Contractual requirements

• Applicable external obligations

• Existing system behavior

• Defect and incident findings

• Technical or operational constraints

• AI-generated requirements

• Autonomous software analysis

• Derived requirements from other governed requirements

Each material requirement should remain traceable to its source or derivation basis.

Where the source is uncertain, reconstructed, or unavailable, that condition shall remain explicit.

Requirement Source ≠ Requirement Authority.

A source may provide information relevant to requirements formation without being competent to authorize the requirement.

Purpose Alignment

RSPM shall evaluate proposed requirements against the applicable Governed

Software Purpose State.

A requirement should have an identifiable relationship to:

• The intended software outcome

• A necessary capability

• An applicable constraint

• A relevant operating condition

• A legitimate supporting requirement

Requirements without a defensible relationship to the governed purpose

shall be identified for clarification, justification, rejection, or separate purpose reassessment.

A technically attractive feature does not automatically belong to the intended software.

Technical Usefulness ≠ Purpose Alignment.

Where a proposed requirement materially changes the software's intended purpose, the issue shall be referred to SPDM rather than silently incorporated into the specification.

Requirements Interpretation Governance

Proposed requirements may be expressed through natural language, structured data, diagrams, examples, software behavior, or machine-generated representations.

RSPM shall distinguish the original expression from the interpretation used

to form the specification.

Where material interpretation is necessary, the resulting specification should preserve:

• The original requirement expression

• The interpreted meaning

• Material assumptions

• Alternative interpretations where relevant

• The source of interpretation

• Unresolved ambiguity

• Relevant confirmation or acceptance evidence

This distinction is particularly important in AI-assisted software development.

Requested Behavior ≠ Interpreted Behavior.

An AI-generated interpretation shall not automatically become the accepted

meaning of a requirement.

Requirements Specification Quality

RSPM shall assess whether each material requirement is sufficiently specified for its intended governance use.

Relevant quality dimensions include:

Clarity: The intended meaning can be understood without material unresolved ambiguity.

Specificity: The required capability, condition, or constraint is sufficiently defined.

Consistency: The requirement does not contain unresolved material contradictions.

Assessability: Applicable satisfaction or verification conditions can be identified.

Purpose Alignment: The requirement supports the relevant governed

software purpose.

Contextual Adequacy: Material operating conditions and assumptions are represented.

Traceability: The requirement remains identifiable and connected to its

relevant sources and governance states.

Change Discernibility: Material changes in requirement meaning can be identified.

Not every requirement requires the same degree of technical detail.

Specification sufficiency depends on the requirement's purpose,

criticality, and lifecycle context.

Specification Detail ≠ Specification Quality.

Requirement Classification

RSPM shall support classification where classification materially affects specification, assessment, or downstream governance.

Requirements may concern:

• Functional behavior

• Performance

• Reliability and availability

• Security and privacy

• Safety

• Accessibility and usability

• Data handling

• Interoperability

• Operational constraints

• Maintenance and support

• Continuity and recovery

• External obligations

• Other relevant software characteristics

Classification shall not replace the competent governance domains

responsible for validating specialized requirements.

A security requirement, for example, remains a software requirement while

its substantive security adequacy may require assessment under the applicable security governance process.

Requirement Granularity and Decomposition

Requirements may be expressed at different levels of abstraction.

RSPM shall distinguish high-level objectives from requirements sufficiently

detailed for downstream assessment.

Where necessary, a requirement may be decomposed into subordinate requirements.

Decomposition should preserve:

• The parent requirement

• The reason for decomposition

• The resulting subordinate requirements

• Material dependencies

• Coverage of the parent requirement

• Unresolved gaps or overlaps

A decomposition shall not silently introduce a materially new purpose or

obligation.

Requirement Decomposition ≠ Authority to Expand Requirements.

The number of subordinate requirements does not establish that the original requirement has been completely represented.

Requirement Conditions and Constraints

A requirement may depend on conditions that materially affect its meaning.

RSPM shall identify relevant:

• Preconditions

• Trigger conditions

• Operating states

• Input conditions

• Output conditions

• Exception conditions

• Environmental assumptions

• Dependencies

• Applicable constraints

Requirements should distinguish required behavior under normal conditions from behavior required during failures, interruptions, degraded operation, or other materially relevant circumstances.

A specification describing only the expected successful path may be insufficient for the intended software purpose.

Normal Operation Specification ≠ Complete Operational Behavior

Specification.

Requirement Assessability and Acceptance Criteria

RSPM shall establish whether a requirement can be meaningfully assessed.

Where appropriate, a specification should identify:

• The expected behavior or condition

• The applicable evaluation context

• Relevant observable outcomes

• Material thresholds or tolerances

• Applicable exception conditions

• The basis for determining whether the requirement has been satisfied

Requirements may be qualitative, quantitative, conditional, or constraint-based.

RSPM does not require every requirement to be reduced to a numerical metric.

However, requirements whose satisfaction cannot be meaningfully assessed

shall not be represented as fully assessable without qualification.

Requirement Statement ≠ Verification Condition.

Defining assessment criteria does not establish that the requirement has been satisfied.

Requirements Completeness Governance

RSPM shall evaluate whether the proposed requirements set sufficiently

represents the applicable governed software purpose.

Completeness shall be assessed relative to:

• The recognized software purpose

• The intended software capabilities

• Material operating scenarios

• Known failure and exception conditions

• Applicable constraints

• Relevant interfaces and dependencies

• Material stakeholder and operational needs

• Known assumptions and unresolved questions

Completeness does not require enumeration of every conceivable future condition.

It requires sufficient coverage of the material requirements necessary for

the declared purpose and applicable assessment context.

Requirements Consistency ≠ Requirements Completeness.

A specification can be internally consistent while omitting an essential requirement.

Requirements Coverage Assessment

RSPM shall support an identifiable relationship between the governed

software purpose and the requirements intended to realize it.

The assessment should identify which material purpose dimensions are:

Covered: Sufficiently represented by specified requirements.

Partially Covered: Represented, but with material gaps.

Uncovered: Not adequately represented.

Unresolved: Coverage cannot yet be determined.

Coverage should not be inferred merely from the number of requirements.

Requirement Volume ≠ Purpose Coverage.

Where material coverage gaps exist, they shall remain visible in the specification state.

Missing Requirements and Hidden Assumptions

RSPM shall identify material missing requirements and assumptions that have not been expressed as requirements.

Examples may include:

• Undefined failure handling

• Missing recovery behavior

• Unspecified access restrictions

• Unaddressed interface failures

• Undefined data retention conditions

• Unclear human intervention requirements

• Assumed availability of external systems

• Unspecified behavior during interrupted operations

A missing requirement shall not automatically be converted into an accepted

requirement.

RSPM may identify, formulate, and propose it for evaluation.

Recognition and acceptance remain subject to the applicable competent

process.

Identified Gap ≠ Authorized New Requirement.

Requirements Consistency and Conflict

RSPM shall identify material conflicts within and between specified requirements.

Conflicts may concern:

• Contradictory required behaviors

• Incompatible thresholds

• Mutually exclusive operating conditions

• Conflicting data handling requirements

• Inconsistent terminology

• Contradictory interface expectations

• Incompatible dependencies

• Conflicts with the governed software purpose

Where conflicts can be resolved through clarification, the resolution should preserve the original conflicting statements and the basis for reconciliation.

Where resolution requires a substantive decision outside RSPM's competence, the conflict shall remain explicit.

Conflict Detection ≠ Authority to Resolve Conflict.

Requirements Dependencies

Requirements may depend on other requirements, software components, external systems, operating conditions, or governed constraints.

RSPM shall identify dependencies that materially affect the meaning, feasibility, completeness, or assessability of a requirement.

Dependencies may be:

• Prerequisite

• Conditional

• Shared

• Conflicting

• External

• Unverified

Where a requirement depends on another requirement, changes to either may affect the validity of the specification.

RSPM identifies these relationships.

Detailed software dependency lifecycle governance remains within the competent SLGA™ dependency domain.

Requirements Priority and Obligation

RSPM shall distinguish a requirement's importance from its binding status.

A requirement may be:

• Mandatory under an applicable competent basis

• Conditionally required

• Optional

• Proposed for future consideration

• Subject to unresolved obligation status

Priority may express implementation urgency or relative importance.

Obligation expresses whether the requirement is binding under the applicable governance context.

High Priority ≠ Mandatory Obligation.

Technical Recommendation ≠ Binding Requirement.

RSPM shall preserve the identified basis for material obligation claims

without independently creating legal, contractual, or organizational authority.

Requirements Operational Reality Alignment

A requirement may be clear, consistent, and assessable while depending on operational conditions that do not exist.

RSPM shall identify material assumptions concerning:

• Available infrastructure

• Data availability and quality

• System interfaces

• Operating environments

• Resource conditions

• Human capabilities

• External services

• Technical or organizational dependencies

Where operational feasibility has not been established, the specification shall preserve that limitation.

RSPM may identify the need for competent validation.

It does not independently certify operational feasibility.

Requirements Consistency ≠ Operational Feasibility.

Specified Capability ≠ Demonstrated Capability.

Requirements Generated by AI and Autonomous Systems

RSPM applies equally to human-authored and machine-generated requirements.

Where AI agents or autonomous systems interpret, derive, or propose requirements, the specification process shall preserve:

• The originating objective

• The source of the generated requirement

• The relevant interpretation or derivation

• Material assumptions

• Proposed scope changes

• Applicable authority boundaries

• The evaluation and acceptance state

An AI system may generate a technically coherent requirement that is not authorized, necessary, or aligned with the governed software purpose.

Requirement Generation Capability ≠ Requirements Governance Authority.

Task Authority ≠ Constituent Action Authority.

Automated requirement generation shall not silently convert a proposed

requirement into an accepted requirement.

Requirements Under Distributed Development

Software requirements may be created and modified across multiple teams, suppliers, repositories, agents, and organizational boundaries.

RSPM shall preserve sufficient specification identity and context to

prevent materially different interpretations from being treated as equivalent requirements.

Relevant controls include:

• Stable requirement references

• Explicit specification versions

• Shared definitions

• Identifiable interpretation differences

• Material conflict detection

• Recognition of unresolved requirements

• Traceable specification handoffs

A requirement interpreted consistently within one team may still conflict with the interpretation used elsewhere.

Shared Requirement Identifier ≠ Shared Requirement Meaning.

Requirement Specification States

RSPM shall represent the current governance condition of specified

requirements.

Possible states include:

Proposed: A requirement has been submitted or generated.

Under Specification: Its meaning or structure is being established.

Specified: The requirement has reached a defined specification state.

Conditionally Specified: The specification remains dependent on explicit

unresolved conditions.

Ambiguous: Material interpretation uncertainty remains.

Conflicted: Material contradictions remain unresolved.

Incomplete: The requirement or relevant requirements set lacks necessary

information or coverage.

Evidence-Limited: Material supporting evidence is insufficient.

Ready for Acceptance Evaluation: The specification is sufficiently developed for the applicable acceptance process.

Accepted: Competent acceptance has been established and recorded.

Rejected: The requirement has been rejected through an applicable competent process.

Superseded: A later specification has replaced the previous state.

Withdrawn: The requirement has been withdrawn through an applicable process.

The distinction between specification readiness and acceptance shall remain

explicit.

Specified Requirement ≠ Accepted Requirement.

Accepted Requirement ≠ Applicable Baseline Requirement.

Acceptance and baseline incorporation must remain subject to the applicable SRS governance conditions, including scope and applicability.

Requirements Acceptance Boundary

RSPM may support acceptance evaluation by producing sufficiently specified requirements and preserving relevant evidence.

It shall not treat specification completeness, technical feasibility, or

automated approval as independent evidence of competent acceptance.

An accepted requirement should preserve, where applicable:

• The accepted requirement identity and version

• The competent acceptance source

• The acceptance context

• Material acceptance conditions

• Relevant limitations

• Effective applicability references

Where acceptance evidence is absent, the requirement shall not be represented as unconditionally accepted.

Specification Readiness ≠ Acceptance Authority.

Specification Change and Version Integrity

Requirements specifications may evolve through clarification, correction, decomposition, or substantive change.

RSPM shall distinguish:

Editorial Change: A change that does not materially alter requirement meaning.

Clarification: A change that resolves ambiguity while preserving the recognized intended requirement.

Substantive Change: A change affecting required behavior, obligation,

conditions, or intended outcome.

New Requirement: A newly introduced requirement that is not merely a reformulation of an existing one.

Material changes shall preserve the relationship between previous and

current specification states.

A substantive change shall be referred to the applicable requirements

change governance process.

Specification Revision ≠ Automatically Authorized Requirements Change.

RCCM governs the competent change-control process.

Evidence, Provenance, and Specification Integrity

RSPM shall preserve evidence sufficient to reconstruct the material basis

of a requirements specification.

Relevant evidence may include:

• Original requests

• Governed software purpose references

• Requirement derivation records

• Clarification records

• Applicable constraints

• Operational assumptions

• Conflict assessments

• Completeness and coverage findings

• Acceptance references

• Specification change history

Where the same underlying evidence is repeated through multiple automated processes, repetition shall not automatically be treated as independent corroboration.

Where evidence is missing, conflicting, outdated, or potentially compromised, the resulting limitation shall remain explicit.

Repeated Interpretation ≠ Independent Confirmation.

Documented Specification ≠ Validated Specification.

RSPM shall not suppress material uncertainty to produce an apparently

complete requirements set.

Requirements Specification Reassessment

A requirements specification shall remain capable of reassessment.

Reassessment may be triggered by:

• Changes to the governed software purpose

• New material requirements

• Discovery of missing requirements

• Material interpretation conflicts

• Changes in operational assumptions

• New applicable constraints

• Changes in software interfaces or dependencies

• Material software incidents

• Autonomous reinterpretation of existing requirements

• Evidence that the current specification no longer represents the

intended outcome.

Reassessment shall identify affected requirements and the need for

competent change control, scope reassessment, or renewed acceptance.

Historical Specification Sufficiency ≠ Continued Specification

Sufficiency.

Governed Software Requirements Specification State

The principal output of RSPM is: Governed Software Requirements Specification State

The state shall preserve sufficient information to identify:

Software Purpose Reference: The applicable Governed Software Purpose

State.

Requirements Set Identity: The identifiable set of requirements

undergoing governance.

Requirement Identities: Stable references and relevant versions.

Requirement Origins: Sources and material derivation relationships.

Requirement Statements: The specified behavior, capability, condition, or

constraint.

Requirement Classification: Relevant functional or non-functional

categories.

Specification Quality: Clarity, specificity, consistency, and

assessability.

Purpose Alignment: The relationship between requirements and the governed

software purpose.

Requirements Completeness: Material completeness findings and limitations.

Requirements Coverage: Covered, partially covered, uncovered, and

unresolved purpose dimensions.

Requirements Conflicts: Material contradictions and reconciliation

conditions.

Operational Assumptions: Conditions requiring confirmation or validation.

Requirements Dependencies: Material prerequisite and conditional

relationships.

Obligation State: Applicable mandatory, conditional, optional, or

unresolved status.

Specification State: The current state of each requirement and the

requirements set.

Acceptance Boundary: Applicable acceptance evidence, conditions, or

unresolved authority questions.

Evidence and Provenance: Supporting sources and material limitations.

Uncertainty: Material unresolved interpretation or evidence conditions.

Version and Continuity: Relevant specification history and superseded

states.

Handoff Conditions: Information required for subsequent software scope

governance.

The state does not independently establish that every requirement is accepted or applicable to a software baseline.

Minimum Implementation Framework

A conforming implementation of RSPM must provide the following six functional capabilities.

• Requirement Object, Origin, and Purpose Alignment Governance

Capability to identify requirements, preserve their origin and versions,

and assess their relationship to the applicable Governed Software Purpose State.

The implementation must distinguish a proposed requirement from a purpose-aligned and sufficiently specified requirement.

• Requirement Interpretation, Formulation, and Classification Governance

Capability to transform proposed requirements into identifiable

specifications while preserving original expressions, material interpretations, classifications, assumptions, and unresolved ambiguity.

The implementation must not treat AI-generated interpretation as automatically accepted requirement meaning.

• Specification Quality, Assessability, and Operational Conditions

Governance

Capability to assess clarity, specificity, internal consistency, assessment

conditions, relevant operating scenarios, dependencies, and material operational assumptions.

The implementation must distinguish specification sufficiency from verified operational feasibility.

• Requirements Completeness, Coverage, and Conflict Governance

Capability to evaluate material requirements completeness against the

governed software purpose, identify coverage gaps, detect contradictions, preserve unresolved conflicts, and distinguish missing requirements from authorized additions.

The implementation must not infer completeness from requirement volume or internal consistency alone.

• Requirements State, Evidence, and Continuity Governance

Capability to preserve specification states, acceptance boundaries,

supporting evidence, uncertainty, versions, substantive changes, and reassessment triggers.

The implementation must distinguish specification readiness from competent acceptance and refer substantive changes to RCCM.

• Governed Specification State and Scope Handoff Governance

Capability to produce a Governed Software Requirements Specification State

with sufficiently explicit requirement identities, meanings, purpose relationships, completeness findings, applicability questions, conflicts, and evidence for subsequent Software Scope Management.

The implementation must preserve material limitations and unresolved conditions during handoff.

GIE™ Compatibility

RSPM is compatible with GIE™ as a downstream methodological execution and analysis layer.

GIE™ may support:

• Requirement discovery and structured extraction

• Interpretation comparison and ambiguity detection

• Purpose alignment assessment

• Requirement classification

• Completeness and coverage analysis

• Conflict and dependency identification

• Evidence and provenance mapping

• Specification state representation

• Reassessment and downstream handoff

Automated assessments shall preserve the distinction between

machine-generated findings and competent governance determinations.

GIE™ must not independently grant requirements acceptance authority, eliminate unresolved uncertainty, or alter canonical RSPM governance logic to accommodate software implementation limitations.

OOF® logic adapts to the governed reality. The engine adapts to OOF®

logic.

Governance Logic

The canonical RSPM governance logic is:

Receive Governed Software Purpose State

↓

Identify Proposed Requirements and Sources

↓

Establish Requirement Identities

↓

Preserve Original Expressions and Interpretations

↓

Assess Purpose Alignment

↓

Formulate and Classify Requirements

↓

Identify Required Behavior, Conditions, and Constraints

↓

Assess Specification Clarity and Assessability

↓

Identify Material Dependencies and Operational Assumptions

↓

Assess Requirements Completeness Against Governed Purpose

↓

Assess Requirements Coverage

↓

Identify Missing Requirements and Hidden Assumptions

↓

Assess Consistency and Detect Conflicts

↓

Clarify or Reconcile Where Competent

↓

Preserve Unresolved Ambiguity and Conflict

↓

Assess Evidence Sufficiency and Uncertainty

↓

Determine Specification and Acceptance States

↓

Establish Governed Software Requirements Specification State

↓

Preserve Identity, Versions, and Provenance

↓

Handoff to Software Scope Management

↓

Reassess When Material Requirements Conditions Change

The principal output is:

Governed Software Requirements Specification State

Governance Outputs

RSPM may produce:

- Software Requirement Governance Object

- Requirements Set Identity - Requirement Origin Record - Requirement Interpretation Record - Requirement Specification - Requirement Classification Record - Purpose Alignment State - Specification Quality Assessment - Requirement Assessability State - Requirement Conditions Record - Requirements Decomposition Record - Requirements Completeness Assessment - Requirements Coverage State - Missing Requirements Record - Operational Assumption Record - Requirements Conflict Record - Requirements Reconciliation Record - Requirements Dependency Record - Requirement Obligation State - Requirement Specification State - Requirements Acceptance Boundary Record - Requirements Evidence State - Requirements Uncertainty Record - Specification Version Record - Specification Reassessment Record - Requirements Scope Handoff Record

The principal output is:

Governed Software Requirements Specification State

Critical Distinctions

RSPM preserves the following distinctions:

Documented Requirement ≠ Governed Requirement Specification

Requirement Identity ≠ Requirement Wording

Requirement Source ≠ Requirement Authority

Requested Behavior ≠ Interpreted Behavior

Technical Usefulness ≠ Purpose Alignment

Specification Detail ≠ Specification Quality

Requirement Decomposition ≠ Authority to Expand Requirements

Normal Operation Specification ≠ Complete Operational Behavior

Specification

Requirement Statement ≠ Verification Condition

Requirements Consistency ≠ Requirements Completeness

Requirement Volume ≠ Purpose Coverage

Identified Gap ≠ Authorized New Requirement

Conflict Detection ≠ Authority to Resolve Conflict

High Priority ≠ Mandatory Obligation

Technical Recommendation ≠ Binding Requirement

Requirements Consistency ≠ Operational Feasibility

Specified Capability ≠ Demonstrated Capability

Requirement Generation Capability ≠ Requirements Governance Authority

Task Authority ≠ Constituent Action Authority

Shared Requirement Identifier ≠ Shared Requirement Meaning

Specified Requirement ≠ Accepted Requirement

Accepted Requirement ≠ Applicable Baseline Requirement

Specification Readiness ≠ Acceptance Authority

Specification Revision ≠ Automatically Authorized Requirements Change

Repeated Interpretation ≠ Independent Confirmation

Documented Specification ≠ Validated Specification

Historical Specification Sufficiency ≠ Continued Specification Sufficiency

Cross-Architecture Boundary

RSPM governs requirements specification within SRS and SLGA™.

It does not replace competent governance of authority, accountability, validation, operational reality, software quality, security, or autonomous systems.

Relevant interoperating architectures may include:

GOA™ — Governance Architecture: General authority, mandate, and

delegation boundaries.

AGA™ — Accountability Governance Architecture: Applicable responsibility

and accountability conditions.

ASGA™ — Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture: Autonomous system

authority and execution boundaries.

ORA™ — Operational Reality Architecture: Competent assessment of

operational reality conditions.

VALIDOS™: Applicable validation methodology.

ADIT®: Broader evidence and auditability governance.

Within SRS:

SPDM establishes the Governed Software Purpose State.

RSPM governs requirements interpretation, specification, completeness,

consistency, and assessability.

SSMM governs detailed requirements scope and applicability.

RCCM governs requirements changes and their competent control.

RTM governs requirements traceability across relevant lifecycle

relationships.

Within the wider SLGA™ architecture, subsequent Parent Standards govern software creation, dependencies, configuration, quality, security, release, deployment, change management, retirement, and cross-cutting lifecycle control.

RSPM may produce requirements relevant to those domains without replacing their competent governance processes.

Canonical Boundary

RSPM begins when proposed software requirements must be interpreted, specified, and evaluated against an applicable Governed Software Purpose State.

RSPM governs:

• Requirement identification

• Requirement origin and interpretation

• Purpose alignment

• Requirement formulation

• Requirement classification

• Requirement granularity and decomposition

• Requirement conditions and constraints

• Specification quality

• Requirement assessability

• Requirements completeness

• Requirements coverage

• Missing requirements

• Requirements consistency

• Requirements conflicts

• Requirements dependencies

• Requirement priority and obligation distinction

• Operational assumptions

• AI-generated and autonomous requirements

• Distributed specification consistency

• Specification states

• Acceptance boundaries

• Specification evidence and provenance

• Specification version integrity

• Specification reassessment

• Requirements handoff

RSPM does not independently determine:

• General organizational or legal authority

• Recognition of a materially new software purpose

• Final requirements scope and baseline applicability

• Authorization of substantive requirements changes

• Complete lifecycle traceability governance

• Software implementation

• Software quality or security conformance

• Operational feasibility certification

• Software release or deployment authorization

RSPM ends when the relevant requirements have been represented as a:

Governed Software Requirements Specification State

with sufficient identification, clarity, purpose alignment, completeness

assessment, consistency, assessability, evidence, and explicit unresolved conditions for subsequent Software Scope Management.

• Use Case 1 — Every Requirement Is Clear, but the Software Still Fails

Its Purpose

A logistics company commissions software to manage warehouse deliveries.

The specification includes:

• Shipment registration

• Delivery scheduling

• Driver assignment

• Delivery confirmation

• Status reporting

Each requirement is clearly written.

The development team implements the specified functions correctly.

However, the software cannot adequately handle deliveries when network connectivity is interrupted.

The original specification did not establish the required behavior for

temporary disconnection, delayed synchronization, or recovery after failed confirmation.

The problem is not necessarily a contradiction within the existing requirements.

It is a material completeness gap.

RSPM evaluates the requirements set against the governed software purpose

and relevant operating scenarios.

It identifies missing requirements concerning:

Offline Operation

Recovery Behavior

Synchronization Conditions

Failure Handling

Operational Continuity

The resulting specification state may remain:

Incomplete

until the missing requirements are formulated and evaluated through the applicable governance process.

Requirements Consistency ≠ Requirements Completeness.

The module identifies the missing foundation before the requirements set is treated as sufficiently specified for its intended purpose.

• Use Case 2 — An AI Coding Agent Invents a Requirement That Was Never

Authorized

A company uses an autonomous coding agent to develop an internal

document-management application.

The original request is:

“Allow authorized employees to search and retrieve documents relevant to

their projects.”

During requirements generation, the agent introduces an additional

requirement:

“The system shall automatically provide organization-wide access to all

indexed documents to improve search performance.”

The generated requirement is clear.

It may also be technically implementable.

However, it expands access beyond the original request and may conflict with applicable access restrictions.

RSPM preserves the distinction between:

Original Request

Agent Interpretation

Generated Requirement

Purpose Alignment Assessment

Specification Evaluation

Acceptance State

The module identifies the generated requirement as requiring additional

governance evaluation.

It does not treat the agent's interpretation as evidence that the organization authorized the expanded access.

The requirement may remain:

Proposed

or:

Conflicted

until the relevant authority and specification questions are resolved.

Requirement Generation Capability ≠ Requirements Governance Authority.

Task Authority ≠ Constituent Action Authority.

RSPM allows automated software development to remain productive without

allowing automated interpretation to silently redefine the requirements that govern it.

Canonical Closing Statement

Software requirements are the point at which an intended purpose becomes a specification that developers, automated systems, and downstream governance processes can act upon.

That transformation is not merely a documentation task.

A requirement can be clearly written and still be unauthorized.

It can be internally consistent and still leave a material gap.

It can be technically feasible and still be disconnected from the intended software purpose.

It can be generated by an advanced AI system and still represent an unsupported interpretation of the original request.

And a complete-looking specification can still omit the conditions under which the software must operate.

Documented Requirement ≠ Governed Requirement Specification.

Requirements Consistency ≠ Requirements Completeness.

Requirement Volume ≠ Purpose Coverage.

Specified Requirement ≠ Accepted Requirement.

Requirement Generation Capability ≠ Requirements Governance Authority.

RSPM establishes the governance conditions under which proposed

requirements become sufficiently explicit, assessable, coherent, and purpose-aligned specifications.

It preserves what was requested, what was interpreted, what was specified,

what remains uncertain, and what has or has not been legitimately accepted.

It does not authorize software implementation merely because a specification is technically ready.

RSPM transforms proposed software requirements into governed specification

states — ensuring that software development proceeds from identifiable meaning, assessed completeness, preserved evidence, and legitimate acceptance boundaries rather than undocumented assumptions or ungoverned interpretation.